

Import Of Equine Species Of Animals From The Countries Where Contagious Equine Metritis Is Reported

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Import Of Equine Species Of Animals From The Countries Where Contagious Equine Metritis Is Reported

UNION OF INDIA

India

Import Of Equine Species Of Animals From The Countries Where Contagious Equine Metritis Is Reported

Rule

IMPORT-OF-EQUINE-SPECIES-OF-ANIMALS-FROM-THE-COUNTRIES-WHERE-CONTAGIOUS-EQUINE-METRITIS-
-IS-REPORTED of 1999

Published on 11 August 1999

Commenced on 11 August 1999

[This is the version of this document from 11 August 1999.]

[Note: The original publication document is not available and this content could not be verified.]

Import Of Equine Species Of Animals From The Countries Where Contagious Equine Metritis Is Reported

Published vide Notification No. G.S.R. 585(E), dated 11th August, 1999

Ministry of Agriculture

(Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying)

G.S.R. 585(E). - In exercise of the powers conferred by Sub-section (1) of section 3 of the Livestock Importation Act,
1898 (Act

9 of 1898

) as amended by Livestock Importation Amendment Act, 1953 (Act 1 of 1953) and in supersession of the notification of the Government of India in the Ministry of Agriculture No. 50-22/77-LDT(AQ)/Pt. dated the 4th February, 1998, the Central Government hereby prohibits with immediate effect import of equine species of animals from the countries where Contagious Equine Metritis is reported during the last three years, or from any other country whose equine stock meant for import into India had originated from, or reared in, or visited any of the Contagious Equine Metritis Infected countries during the immediate past two years prior to importation, except males upto seven years and females upto five years of age which have never been mated or were in contact with the breeding stock: -

Provided that, in addition to the health requirements specified under the Act, the equines to be imported into India are accompanied by a Veterinary Health Certificate from an authorised Veterinarian stating that the animals have not been in contact with the breeding stock during the last two years and that the swabs collected from prepuce, urethra, vagina and cervix of these animals were found negative for pathogenic micro-organisms specifically *Taylorella equigenitalis*, by standard culture on three consecutive testing during thirty days immediately prior to embarkation for export:

Provided further that such imported equines on arrival in India shall be kept in quarantine for a minimum period of thirty days at the Government Quarantine Stations. During this quarantine period, the imported equines shall be subjected to bacteriological and serological examinations by recognised laboratories, on three consecutive occasions, conducted at weekly intervals and shall be permitted to mix with other stock only when declared negative for Contagious Equine Metritis infection and Quarantine Officer shall examine the equine as per health protocol specified in the Schedule;

The equine shall only be imported through the international airports of Delhi, Calcutta, Mumbai and Chennai, or any other airport notified by the Government from time to time.

Schedule

Health Protocol for Importation of Equines

1.

The equines should come from a country free from African Horse Sickness.

(a)

. In case of Thoroughbred horses, import will be allowed for breeding purposes only.

2.

During one hundred eighty days immediately prior to export, the equine should have not visited any country where African Horse Sickness occurred in the past two years immediately preceding the export.

3.

The equine being imported has been kept in isolation for thirty days in an approved Government quarantine station and subjected to the following tests with negative results :

Disease

Diagnostic Test

(1)

(2)

(3)

Glanders

Mallein/Complement Fixation Test (CFT)

Fifteen days before embarkation.

Dourine

Complement Fixation Test (CFT)

Fifteen days before embarkation.

Equine Infections Anaemia

Coggins (Immunodiffusion Test)

Thirty days before embarkation.

Infections Equine Abortion (*Salmonella abortus equi*)

Serum Agglutination Test (titre not greater than one/three thousand)

Fifteen days before embarkation.

Equine Viral Arteritis (EVA)

Virus Neutralisation Test

Two occasions at least fourteen days apart with negative result during twenty eight days prior to shipment

Contagious Equine Metritis

Culture of microorganism

Three consecutive tests at weekly interval during pre-export quarantine period with negative results.

Equine Piroplasmiasis (*Babesia equi* and *Babesia caballi*)

Complement Fixation Test (CFT)/ Indirect Fluorescent Antibody Test (IFAT)

30 days before embarkation.

Venezuelan equine Encephalomyelitis

Haemagglutination Inhibition (HI)/ Complement Fixation Test (CFT)/ Plaque Reduction Neutralisation Test (PRNT)

Not less than fourteen days after the commencement of pre-export quarantine.

Equine Morbilli Virus

Serum Neutralisation Test(SNT)

N.B. : No testing is necessary in respect of such diseases which do not occur in the exporting country. However, a certificate from a qualified veterinarian should be furnished certifying freedom from the disease.

4.

The equines should not show any clinical signs or symptoms of infectious or contagious diseases including African Horse Sickness, Epizootic Lymphangitis, Ulcerative Lymphangitis, Trypanosomiasis, Dourine, Equine Piroplasmiasis, Equine Rhinopneumonitis, Equine Encephalomyelitis, Equine Influenza, Equine Infectious Anaemia, Potomac Horse Fever, Getah Virus and Vesicular Stomatitis on the day of shipment and during the three month prior to shipment.

5.

The equines have to be kept for three months prior to shipment in an establishment where no infectious or contagious disease was reported and no such diseases reported in a radius of twenty kilometers around such establishment.

6.

All animals prior to export should have been vaccinated with Equine Influenza (Killed) bivalent vaccine, and the last vaccination should be within fifteen to thirty days prior to embarkation.

7.

All equipments, containers, vehicles and parts of the vessels or aircraft used for transportation of the equines were cleaned and disinfected using disinfectant approved for the purpose by the Government Veterinary Authorities.

8.

After import in India, the equines should be kept in quarantine for a minimum period of (thirty) days at the Government Quarantine Station or premises specifically approved by the Ministry of Agriculture for this purpose. During this quarantine period, the equines shall be subjected to standard culture and serological examination for contagious equine metritis infection by a recognised laboratory on three consecutive occasions at seven days interval and shall be permitted to mix with other stock only when declared negative for Contagious Equine Metritis infection.

9.

Equines imported from countries other than those reported infectious must not have been boarded in any of the infected countries during the period commencing twelve months prior to embarkation for export from the exporting country.

9.1

A certificate issued by an authorised veterinarian of the exporting country to the effect that the country has remained free of Contagious Equine Metritis disease during the three years immediately prior to export must accompany the consignment.

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